

## Chapter 135-1

Moonlight spilled through the window lattice, casting a hazy glow over the plush toys on the bay window.

Only a dim yellow bedside lamp was lit in the room.

Xu Qingzhu's voice was fragmented with sobs, like a homeless cat on a snowy night.

The wind had picked up outside, blowing fine snow. The withered branches, unable to bear the weight, swayed with the wind and shook off the snow that had covered them.

The moment the snow fell, it had the beauty of "as if the Milky Way were tumbling down from the ninth heaven"<sup>1</sup>—drifting and scattering, tinged with the silver radiance of moonlight.

The tips of Liang Shi's hair were dampened with Xu Qingzhu's sweat. The room was filled with the rich, lingering scent of strawberry Baileys, mixed with the White Silver Needle tea<sup>2</sup> fragrance from her body.

To Liang Shi, the sweet strawberry scent was much richer than the tea scent.

But to Xu Qingzhu, the tea fragrance of White Silver Needle was more intense than her own strawberry scent.

It was clearly such a light and ascetic tea fragrance, yet after smelling it, it could stir every cell in her body.

Xu Qingzhu's tears had soaked the pillow.

Outside, a cat from who knows whose home let out a sharp cry, as if someone had stepped on its tail.

It formed an interlocking symphony with the sounds Xu Qingzhu made in the room.

The night gradually deepened.

//

Xu Qingzhu was covered in sweat, as if she had been washed with water. The bed sheets were also sticky.

Liang Shi carried Xu Qingzhu to take a bath.

The bathroom here was small, with no bathtub—they could only shower. But Xu Qingzhu couldn't even stand steadily. When entering the bathroom, her legs went weak and her feet slipped, nearly causing her to fall.

She was casually wearing one of Liang Shi's shirts. There was still some height difference between the two of them.

Though it wasn't too much.

Liang Shi's oversized shirt looked a bit short on Xu Qingzhu, with both slender legs exposed, looking like she was wearing an outfit with a "disappearing bottom half."<sup>3</sup>

When Xu Qingzhu buttoned the shirt, she did it carelessly, misaligning one button.

The collar on both sides at the top was uneven, as was the bottom.

The top wasn't too bad—just a few strawberry marks.<sup>4</sup>

There were more marks on her legs.

Liang Shi was already considered the gentle type. Before doing anything, she would always ask many questions, afraid that Xu Qingzhu would feel uncomfortable, also afraid she would cry.

She coaxed while doing it, but unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu cried even harder.

If she continued, Xu Qingzhu would cry. If she stopped, she would cry even louder.

When extremely frustrated, she would even bite Liang Shi.

The white shirt was of good quality, but since it was meant for summer wear, it was rather thin.

Everything underneath could be seen clearly.

When water from the showerhead accidentally sprayed on her, the white shirt clung tightly to her skin.

Liang Shi lowered her eyes and silently recited a calming mantra in her heart.

Hot water continuously fell from the showerhead, filling the bathroom with hazy steam.

Xu Qingzhu's hair was also drenched, and Liang Shi couldn't escape either.

Originally, she had only wanted to help Xu Qingzhu take a bath so she could sleep peacefully, but now both of them were completely soaked, so they might as well wash together.

---

## Footnotes:

<sup>1</sup> "疑是银河落九天" - A famous line from the Tang dynasty poet Li Bai's poem "Gazing at the Waterfall on Mount Lu" (望庐山瀑布). The original line describes a waterfall so magnificent it seems like the Milky Way falling from the highest heavens. Here it's used poetically to describe the beautiful sight of snow falling in the moonlight.

<sup>2</sup> White Silver Needle (白毫銀針, Bái Háo Yín Zhēn) - One of the most prized and expensive white teas from China, known for its delicate, subtle flavor and silvery-white appearance. It's made only from the unopened buds of the tea plant.

<sup>3</sup> "下身消失" (disappearing bottom half) - A popular fashion trend/style where someone wears an oversized top (usually a shirt or sweater) that's long enough to cover most of the thighs, creating the illusion that they're not wearing pants or shorts underneath.

<sup>4</sup> Strawberry marks (草莓印) - A Chinese slang term for hickeys/love bites, named because they resemble strawberries in color and appearance.

## Chapter 135-2

//

Xu Qingzhu slept until the early hours of the morning, when the heat period struck again.

She pressed close to Liang Shi with her feverish temperature. Liang Shi, who was in the midst of sleep, was startled awake. Still thinking she was in her own world, she reached out to touch Xu Qingzhu's forehead, assuming she had a fever, her heart clenching.

But then Xu Qingzhu climbed over like a snake and kissed her on the lips without any preamble.

Only then did Liang Shi realize that Xu Qingzhu's heat period had arrived.

It was also her first time experiencing such a long heat period, experiencing it together with Xu Qingzhu.

The feeling wasn't bad.

The distant horizon turned the pale white of a fish belly as dawn light grew faint.

The bed sheets became sticky.

When going to shower in the early morning, she could see through the living room window that the outside was covered in a thick layer of wind-blown snow, the entire world a vast expanse of white.

The bathroom was filled with steamy mist.

Hot water fell on their skin. Who knows who initiated first—when their eyes met, they shared a long kiss through the water vapor.

.....

Xu Qingzhu's heat period this time lasted five days, much longer than any of her previous ones.

And presumably because it was her first time being marked by an Alpha, both her emotions and desires were more intense.

For the first two days, she didn't take suppressants and didn't go to work.

Her and Liang Shi's range of activity was pitifully small—only the bedroom and bathroom.

By the third day, she had no choice—she had to go to work. There was a very important meeting to attend. Early in the morning, Liang Shi gave her a suppressant injection and drove her to work. They even ran into Sally and Lin Luoxi downstairs at the company.

After sending Xu Qingzhu to the company, Liang Shi went to greet Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe.

Lunch was at Liang Xinzhou's home. There was no mention of Qiu Zimin or Guo Xinran. Everyone just chatted casually, having a pleasant meal in a happy atmosphere.

In the afternoon, Liang Shi went to visit the Su family, buying some things to see Su Yao.

Su Yao kept asking about her health, whether she had fully recovered. Liang Shi answered each question.

In the evening, Su Yao asked her to stay for dinner.

Liang Shi went to pick up Xu Qingzhu, and the two went to the Su family home together for dinner.

By now, the relationship between Xu Qingzhu and Su Yao had eased considerably. While not extremely close, they could get along warmly.

It was Liang Shi's first time eating at the Su family home.

But because Xu Qingzhu was there, she appeared completely calm and at ease.

After dinner, Su Zhe wanted them to stay overnight, but Xu Qingzhu said: "We still have things to do when we get back. We'll head home first."

Su Zhe: "...?"

Faced with Su Zhe's bewildered expression, Xu Qingzhu didn't explain further.

On the way back, Xu Qingzhu sat in the passenger seat with her eyes closed, her complexion already showing an abnormal flush.

Liang Shi frowned: "Is your suppressant wearing off?"

Xu Qingzhu pressed her legs together and responded softly with an "mm."

She said nothing more.

Liang Shi pushed the car to maximum speed, racing home as fast as possible.

//

Looking back on it later, those few days were quite like "from then on, the emperor never attended morning court."<sup>1</sup>

On several mornings, Xu Qingzhu didn't have time to eat breakfast because there wasn't enough time after finishing a session. In the end, she could only hastily shower and leave, not even having time to dry her hair.

But fortunately, the heat period passed safely.

---

**Footnotes:**

<sup>1</sup> "從此君王不早朝" - A famous line from Bai Juyi's poem "Song of Everlasting Sorrow" (長恨歌), referring to Emperor Xuanzong of Tang who was so enamored with his beloved consort Yang Guifei that he neglected his imperial duties and stopped attending morning court sessions. This phrase is commonly used to describe couples who are so absorbed in each other that they neglect everything else.

## Chapter 135-3

//

The day Liang Shi went to see Chen Liuying was a windy day.

After the snow had just fallen on this coastal city, it didn't warm up but instead started blowing strong winds.

The wind scattered the snow everywhere. The roads that had just been swept were covered with snowflakes again before long, though only a thin layer that would melt into water when the midday sun came out.

After Xu Qingzhu's heat period passed, Liang Shi was finally able to extricate herself from those matters.

When she thought back on those days, they were quite pleasant.

There was nothing to think about—in that small space, there were only the two of them.

One day, after a thoroughly satisfying session, Liang Shi carried Xu Qingzhu, wrapped in a blanket, to the sofa to watch a movie.

She had already forgotten what the movie was about.

The only thing she remembered was that there was a very beautiful kissing scene in the movie.

When the camera turned to that scene, Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu looked at each other simultaneously.

They smiled at each other.

Their slightly curved lips touched, not caring that it was broad daylight, with the cold sunlight refracting in through the window.

Only after they finished did they discover that the sofa cushion was not easy to clean at all. In the end, they had no choice but to order a new sofa cushion online.

After placing the order, Liang Shi figured since they were going to replace it anyway, she took Xu Qingzhu for another round.

After all, they couldn't let the soon-to-be-discarded sofa cushion go to waste.

It was clearly the most ordinary scene, yet in both their eyes, it carried an enchanting atmosphere.

Afterward, they watched movies together several more times, and almost all ended the same way.

Indulging in intimacy could make one's willpower weaken.

At that time, they were like sinking into a safe harbor, not wanting to think about anything, letting their bodies' instincts take over.

Liang Shi wasn't entirely wooden in these matters either. To coax Xu Qingzhu, she would call her "baby," "wife," "Zhuzi," "meimei," and "little princess" when emotions ran deep.

Of course, what she called her most often was still "little princess."

Liang Shi would always sigh helplessly: "Meimei, after all these years, how are you still such a little princess?"

Xu Qingzhu was crying so hard she was gasping for breath, having no time to answer her question.

During Xu Qingzhu's heat period, Liang Shi also paid attention to contraception.

Afraid of harming Xu Qingzhu's body, she later specifically went to buy birth control pills for Alphas.

Except for the first day, when there wasn't time.

But the educational documentary had also mentioned that on the first day of an Omega's heat period, as well as when an Alpha had just marked an Omega, the possibility of pregnancy was extremely low.

By the time she remembered this, time had already passed and there were no remedial measures, so Liang Shi just left it to fate.

Such a low-probability event surely wouldn't happen to her.

After Xu Qingzhu's heat period passed, Liang Shi planned to go see Chen Liuying, Gu Xingyue, Yang Jiani, and Chen Mian.

There were too many people to see. She listed them all for Xu Qingzhu to hear.

Xu Qingzhu's sensitive emotions from just finishing her heat period hadn't completely subsided. Hearing this, she scoffed lightly, "So basically you don't want to spend even a moment with me anymore."

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi felt deeply wronged and immediately hugged her, "Xu Qingzhu, you can't wrong me like this."

"How am I wronging you?" Before anything else happened, Xu Qingzhu's eyes were already red, leaving Liang Shi at a loss for what to do. Fortunately, she had figured out some ways to coax her during these past few days.

Liang Shi leaned in and licked her earlobe in a placating manner.

Xu Qingzhu pushed her, "Don't..."

Liang Shi blew a breath into her ear, "Still angry?"



Xu Qingzhu: "...You're annoying."

"So are you still angry?" As Liang Shi spoke, she was about to repeat the earlier action, but Xu Qingzhu pinched her face, "Are you done yet?"

Liang Shi chuckled softly: "It's all because you forced me to."

Xu Qingzhu lowered her eyes, and before she could even speak, her voice was already choked: "It's because you're mean."

Liang Shi reached out to wipe away her tears, "Okay, I'm mean."

Liang Shi brought her to the sofa and coaxed her in a low voice, "Baby, don't cry anymore."

During these past few days, the phrase Liang Shi said most often was "don't cry anymore."

But an Omega in heat was emotionally fragile, and the more she was told not to cry, the more tears would flow.

There was even one night when Xu Qingzhu cried until she nearly fainted.

After waking up, she continued crying. Liang Shi said she wanted to stop, but Xu Qingzhu cried even harder.

After becoming slightly more lucid, Xu Qingzhu said to Liang Shi in a very soft voice: "Actually, it feels good."

She was crying because it felt too pleasurable.

It was crying from happiness, not from sadness.

Xu Qingzhu also said: "Actually, I don't want to cry either, but I can't stop the tears. There's nothing I can do."

Liang Shi comforted her: "It's all this damn heat period's fault."

Just hearing this one sentence made Xu Qingzhu's eyes redden.

Sometimes Xu Qingzhu's tears wouldn't fall; it was simply that her voice was choked.

During the day when she went to work, her voice was hoarse.

During those nights of revelry, Liang Shi even compared finger lengths with Xu Qingzhu.

They lay side by side on the bed, the room lights bright.

That was also shortly after they had just finished, when Xu Qingzhu still had her rationality and could chat with her.

## Chapter 135-4

Liang Shi looked at Xu Qingzhu's fingers and suddenly said: "Your pinky finger is a bit short."

Xu Qingzhu compared carefully and said somewhat dejectedly: "My pinky doesn't reach past the second knuckle of my index finger. A lot of people's do. You're not the first to say this."

Liang Shi stretched out her own hand to show her: "Mine passes it, and even goes beyond by a bit."

Liang Shi's hands were extremely beautiful—ten slender, fair fingers, with no long nails, looking very clean and neat.

Xu Qingzhu compared and said: "Your middle finger is much longer than your index finger and ring finger."

Liang Shi nodded: "But my ring finger isn't short either, right?"

"Mm." Xu Qingzhu placed her own hand on top, "It's more than a centimeter longer than mine."

Liang Shi chuckled softly: "Well, I'm taller than you too."

This made Xu Qingzhu so annoyed that she kicked her under the blanket.

Only after kicking did she belatedly realize that they seemed to have discussed something completely pointless.

There was another time when they were chatting casually and the topic turned to the days when Liang Shi was unconscious.

Liang Shi explained those days using Zhao Xuning's explanation, saying she had gone on a distant journey and saw Qi Jiao there.

When she heard those two characters "Qi Jiao," Xu Qingzhu's expression changed slightly.

Normally there wouldn't be much of a reaction, but right now her reactions were multiplied. Her brow furrowed slightly, yet Liang Shi still hadn't noticed.

Liang Shi said: "Qi Jiao-jiejie opened a flower shop over there. She's still the same as when we were young—gentle and kind, like an angel. On the first day we met, she gave me milk candy again."

Liang Shi told her about how Qi Jiao gave her irises on the day after the press conference ended, and even confessed her sexual orientation to her.

She said that even though Qi Jiao had lost her memories, she could still instinctively sense that Chen Mian was a painter.

Liang Shi chattered on endlessly, sharing everything from there, and even asked Xu Qingzhu for advice on whether she should tell Chen Mian what Qi Jiao had said to her.

If she told her, how would she explain if Chen Mian asked questions?

But if she didn't tell her, Liang Shi hoped that Qi Jiao could be happy.

Could have the happiness of being with Chen Mian.

Even if she told her, the two of them wouldn't be able to meet. It was truly a dilemma.

After she finished speaking, she noticed that Xu Qingzhu hadn't responded. When she looked down, she found Xu Qingzhu lying in her arms, shedding tears.

Tears were falling in streams. Liang Shi thought she was feeling sad about Chen Mian and Qi Jiao's relationship, and immediately coaxed her: "Baby, it's okay. Qi Jiao is very happy now."

"Right." Xu Qingzhu said: "She's very happy. I'm not happy."

Liang Shi: "?"

"What's wrong?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu's eyelashes were stained with tears, looking incredibly pitiful, "Qi Jiao-jiejie is so wonderful. Why didn't you stay there to be with Qi Jiao? Why did you come back?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"Are you jealous?" Liang Shi teased her while wiping her tears, which was a sort of alternative mischievous pleasure.

Xu Qingzhu let out a soft hum, her little expression looking extremely aggrieved, "How could I be jealous? I want candy."

As it happened, Liang Shi had prepared candy in the bedroom drawer.

She unwrapped the candy wrapper and brought it to Xu Qingzhu's lips. At first, Xu Qingzhu hummed lightly, looking like she wouldn't eat it unless Liang Shi coaxed her properly. But then Liang Shi leaned over and kissed the corner of her mouth.

When she brought the candy to her lips again, Xu Qingzhu obediently opened her mouth.

After Xu Qingzhu had eaten half the candy, Liang Shi leaned over and bit off the other half.

Lips pressed against lips.

Liang Shi ate that half of the candy into her mouth and said with a smile: "So sweet."

Xu Qingzhu huffed in displeasure: "Is the candy Qi Jiao-jiejie gave you sweeter, or the one stolen from my mouth sweeter?"

Liang Shi paused for a moment, pretending to think.

Xu Qingzhu's tears were about to fall again. Liang Shi immediately surrendered, leaned over to kiss her on the lips, "Wifey... don't cry."

Liang Shi bit her earlobe, then lightly grazed it, coaxing: "Of course the one stolen from my wife's mouth is sweeter."

When it was just the two of them, they could say anything.

Completely shameless.

Liang Shi felt like all the lines she had never gotten to say in TV dramas before, she had said them all in these past few days.

Then Xu Qingzhu asked her: "Is it good over there?"

Liang Shi hesitated for a moment, then nodded: "It's good. Everyone loves me a lot. And it's already spring over there. On the day I came over, I had just picked a branch of peach blossoms downstairs and put it on the coffee table."

"Then why did you still come?" Xu Qingzhu said with a hint of sourness: "Over there you have your Qi Jiao-jiejie who gives you irises, and so many people who love you..."

Hearing this, Liang Shi chuckled softly and reached out to pinch her waist.

After a pause, she said: "Because over there... there's no Xu Qingzhu."

"My little princess meimei." Liang Shi's voice was very low, carrying a hint of huskiness: "Where else would I have a wife to feed me candy?"

This made Xu Qingzhu's face turn red all at once.